Team Code Link

A full walkthrough for people who have not set this up before. Read it from the top. Do the steps in order. One person is the host. Every other person follows the join steps on their own computer.

When you are done, up to six Windows computers can see one shared project folder, sit in one private room, and each start the agent program you choose. That program can be Cursor, Claude, ChatGPT, Hermes, or another command on that computer.

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1. The words this guide uses

These words show up on the screen. Here is what each one means in this program.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
Computer	One physical PC. In the room it has a short name you choose, such as `nate` or `office`. That name is the seat.
Agent	The program on this computer that writes code. The Agent tab lists Cursor, Claude, ChatGPT, Hermes, and any other command. Connect starts the one you pick. It does not attach a chat window that is already open.
Room	A private list of who is here, what they said, and which part of the work they are on. It runs on the host computer. It is not a website on the public internet.
Room code	Eight letters and numbers, such as `AB12CD34`. It is the password for this room. The host reads it from the top of the window and sends it to the other people. It is not a web address.
Tailscale	A program that gives each computer a private address starting with `100.` and lets those computers find each other. The project is not shared with the public internet. Only computers you invited can see it.
Tailnet	The private network Tailscale makes for one account. Every computer in this guide must be signed into that same tailnet. Two people with two unrelated Tailscale accounts cannot see each other.
Host	The one computer that starts the room and shares the project folder. Leave its Team Code Link window open the whole time.
Join	What every other computer does. It uses the room code to find the host over Tailscale and enter the room.
Project	The piece of software you are building together. It has a short name, such as `Shared`, and it lives in one ordinary Windows folder.
Source	The one computer whose folder is the real copy of the project. Everyone else opens that folder. Only one computer is the source at a time.
Share path	The address of that folder, written like `\\office\Shared`. The word before the second slash is the host computer. The last word is the project name. If the computer has no usable name, the address uses the `100.` number instead, like `\\100.125.156.83\Shared`.
Conductor	The person in charge of the room. The host becomes the conductor when they click Host and share. The conductor can hear every part and can send instructions once a plan exists.

Part	One piece of the job, such as “the canvas” or “the toolbar.” A plan is the list of parts. The host and the host’s agent agree on that list. Section 9 is when the host says the plan is a go.
Skill	A named ability already installed on that computer, read from a file called `SKILL.md`. The agent brings the checked skills into the room. You do not type skill names by hand.

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2. What you need on every computer

- Windows.
- The program file. Download Team.Code.Link.exe. Section 4 explains that name. The same file is on the fork at Team_code_link-source.
- Tailscale, installed and signed into the same tailnet. Section 3.
- The agent program this computer will run, if it will run one. Section 8 lists Cursor, Claude, ChatGPT, Hermes, and any other command. A computer that only joins and opens the shared folder does not need one.
- Python installed so that the command `python3` works. This is what stops two Cursor agents from saving the same file at the same time. Open PowerShell and type `python3 --version`. If Windows says it cannot find the command, install Python from python.org/downloads/windows, and on the first installer screen turn on “Add python.exe to PATH.” After it finishes, copy `python.exe` to a file named `python3.exe` in that same folder so the command name is `python3`.

> The host computer has one extra requirement. The person who clicks Host and share must start the program with Windows administrator rights. Section 6 explains the exact clicks. The other computers do not need administrator rights just to join.

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3. Put every computer on the same Tailscale network

Do this on the host first, then on every other computer. Tailscale is the private wire. Team Code Link does not replace it.

1. On the host, open a browser and go to https://tailscale.com/download/windows. Download the Windows installer and run it. Approve the Windows prompts.
2. When Tailscale asks you to sign in, create an account or sign in. This account owns the tailnet. A tailnet is the private list of computers that are allowed to see each other.
3. After sign-in, click the Tailscale icon near the clock. It should say Connected. That computer now has a private address that starts with `100.`

4. Invite the other people. In a browser, open https://login.tailscale.com/admin/users. Invite each person by email. They must accept the invite. Signing up for their own separate Tailscale account, and never accepting this invite, leaves them on a different tailnet. Those computers cannot see the host.
5. On each other computer, install Tailscale the same way. Sign in with the invited account. The Tailscale icon should say Connected.
6. On the host, open the Tailscale icon and look at the list of machines. Every computer that will join must appear there. If a computer is missing, it is not on this tailnet yet. Stop and fix the invite before you open Team Code Link.

> You should see each computer in the Tailscale machine list, and each one should show Connected. You do not turn on an exit node, a subnet router, or a public funnel. Those are other Tailscale features. This setup does not use them.

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4. Download Team Code Link onto every computer

The program is a file on the GitHub Releases page. Releases are the download area, separate from the source code. You do not clone the repository to get the program, and you do not build it.

Download this file on every computer, including the host:

https://github.com/N8Skully/Team_code_link/releases/latest/download/Team.Code.Link.exe

The release page, if you want to see the version first, is https://github.com/N8Skully/Team_code_link/releases/latest. The same program is also on the fork: https://github.com/N8Skully/Team_code_link-source/releases/latest/download/Team.Code.Link.exe.

The saved name is `Team.Code.Link.exe`. The dots are there because the download name cannot keep spaces. It is the Team Code Link program. You can leave that name, or rename the file to `Team Code Link.exe`. Either name starts the same program. Use version 0.2.0 or newer. The older file named v0.1.0 does not match this walkthrough.

1. On each computer, open the download link above. The browser saves `Team.Code.Link.exe`. Put it somewhere you can find, such as the Desktop.
2. On the host, right-click that file and choose **Run as administrator** when you are ready for section 6. On a computer that is only joining, a normal double-click is enough.

> The project folder you choose in section 6 is the work everyone shares. Do not pick a Team Code Link source folder as that project folder. The program file and the project files stay separate.

5. Learn the window before you click Host

Double-click `Team Code Link.exe`. A single window opens. It does not open your web browser. The top bar is always visible. Read it from left to right:

ITEM	MEANING
Tailscale	**connected** plus a `100.` address means this computer is on the private network. **not connected** means Tailscale is installed but signed out, or it is not installed. This line is only about Tailscale. It does not mean the agent has joined the room.
Code	The room code, or a dash before anyone hosts. After the host succeeds, this is the eight characters the other people type.
Agent	**not connected** until Connect or Host and share actually starts the agent program. A name such as `nate/cursor` means that seat is in the room. The Agent tab says whether the Cursor program itself is running.
Source	**none** until the host publishes the folder. After that, this is the `\\computer\Project` path.

There are five tabs:

- **Connection.** Tailscale, host or join, the project, and the folder.
- **Agent.** Start the Cursor agent for this computer.
- **Settings.** The saved names and folder. Save stores them. It does not join the room.
- **Skills.** Checkboxes for abilities already on this computer. Uncheck any this agent should not bring.
- **Live.** Who is in the room, what they said, and, after a plan exists, the conductor's instruction boxes.

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6. On the host: start the room and share the folder

Do this on one computer only. Close the window if you already opened it without administrator rights, then start it the way step 1 says.

1. Right-click `Team Code Link.exe`. Click **Run as administrator**. Windows asks "Do you want to allow this app to make changes?" Click **Yes**. Administrator rights are required because Windows will not let a normal program create a shared folder for other computers. If you skip this, the room can still start, and a red line under the button will say to run as administrator. **Source** stays **none** until the share succeeds.

2. Look at the top bar. It must say Tailscale **connected** and show a `100.` address. If it says Tailscale is not installed, go back to section 3. If it says not connected, click **Sign in with Tailscale** and finish the login Tailscale opens. Wait until the bar says connected.
3. Open the **Connection** tab. Set **This computer** to **Host the room**. The button at the bottom then reads **Host and share**.
4. **Project.** Leave `Shared`, or type a short name made of letters, numbers, and hyphens, such as `ToolsProject`. This name becomes the Windows share name. Spaces are not allowed.
5. **Computer.** A short name for this PC in the room, such as `nate`. Lowercase letters, numbers, and hyphens. The box may already contain a suggestion. If the Windows computer name is the word UNKNOWN, the program uses `computer` instead. Capitals are turned into lowercase.
6. **Agent.** Leave `cursor` if this computer will run Cursor's agent. That word is the kind of agent, not the chat title.
7. **Project lives.** This chooses how the files arrive. **On this computer, shared with Tailscale** means the folder you pick in the next step is the real copy, and other computers open it over Tailscale. **In a GitHub repo, copied into a folder here** means the files start on GitHub and the program copies them into the folder once. Section 10 walks through both, including how to put one new file where the other person can open it. You can use both: GitHub holds a saved copy, and Tailscale is how the other computer opens the live folder.
8. **Folder on this computer.** Click **Choose folder**. Pick a new empty folder, for example `C:\Users\YourName\Documents\SharedProject`. This is where the project files will live. Do not pick the Team Code Link program folder.
9. Open the **Skills** tab. Checked rows are sent with this agent. Uncheck anything this agent should not claim. If the list says no SKILL.md files were found, this computer has no skill files in the usual Cursor, Claude, or Codex skill folders. You can still continue.
10. Go back to **Connection** and click **Host and share**. Wait until the window answers. The first time can take a little while because it starts the room, joins this computer, starts the Cursor agent, and creates the Windows share.

> Success looks like this on the top bar:
>
> - Tailscale connected, with a `100.` address.
> - Code shows eight letters and numbers. Send those characters to the other people. Send the code itself, not a web link.
> - Agent shows a name such as `nate/cursor`. Open the Agent tab. It should say that name is running in the project folder. If it says the cursor program is not installed, Cursor's agent program is missing on this computer. Install Cursor, sign in, and click **Connect** on the Agent tab again.
> - Source shows a path starting with `\\`.

> A red line under the button is the reason it stopped. Read it. "Run Team Code Link as administrator" means close the window and do step 1 again. "No computer on Tailscale accepted that code" is a join error, not a host error. "The room did not start" means another Team Code Link window is already holding the room. Close the other one and click Host and share again.

If other computers cannot find the room

The room listens on port 8765. A port is a numbered door on the computer. Host and share opens that door on the Tailscale adapter only. The public internet is not opened. If Windows refuses, the red line says to run Team Code Link as administrator. Close the window, start it with Run as administrator, and click Host and share again.

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7. On every other computer: join the room

Each person does this on their own PC. They need Tailscale connected to the same tailnet, and a copy of `Team Code Link.exe`. They do not need administrator rights to join. They do need the room code from the host.

1. Start `Team Code Link.exe`. The top bar must say Tailscale **connected**.
2. On **Connection**, set **This computer** to **Join a room**. The button changes to **Join**. A **Room code** box appears.
3. Type the eight characters the host sent. No `https://`, no spaces.
4. Set **Computer** to a different short name from the host, such as `office`. Two computers must not use the same seat name.
5. Set **Agent** to `cursor` if this computer will run Cursor.

6. **Folder on this computer** can stay empty for a person who is only joining. The files they share are the host's folder. The source path appears in the top bar after the join finds the host.
7. Click **Join**.

Join works by asking every computer on the tailnet, on port 8765, whether it accepts that code. The host must still be running. If the message is "No computer on Tailscale accepted that code," check three things: both Tailscale icons say Connected, both machines appear in the Tailscale machine list, and the host has allowed port 8765 as in section 6.

> After a successful join, **Code** shows the same eight characters, **Agent** shows this computer's seat, and **Source** shows the host's `\\` path. On the **Live** tab, both seats appear under Agents.

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8. Connect an agent on each computer

A seat on the Live tab is only a name. The agent is connected when the program you picked is actually running. Open the **Agent** tab. The list is the programs this window knows how to start. Pick one, read the line under the list, then click **Connect**.

Connect puts this computer's seat in the room, writes the room tools for that program into the project folder, and starts the program there. It tells the program to say it is connected and then listen. The top bar shows a name such as `office/claude` while that program is running. When the turn ends, the name stays in the room and the Agent tab says the program is not running. Click Connect again for another turn.

Cursor

1. Install Cursor from cursor.com and sign in once.
2. On the Agent tab, choose **Cursor**.
3. Click **Connect**. The window starts Cursor's agent in the project folder. It does not attach a Cursor chat that is already open.

Claude

1. Install Claude Code so that opening PowerShell and typing `claude` starts it.
2. On the Agent tab, choose **Claude**.
3. Click **Connect**. The window starts `claude` in the project folder and gives it the room tools.

ChatGPT

1. Install OpenAI's Codex program so that typing `codex` in PowerShell starts it. Team Code Link uses that program for the ChatGPT agent.

2. On the Agent tab, choose **ChatGPT**.
3. Click **Connect**. The window starts Codex in the project folder.

Hermes

1. Install Hermes so that typing `hermes` in PowerShell starts it.
2. On the Agent tab, choose **Hermes**.
3. Click **Connect**. The window starts Hermes in the project folder and adds the room tools to Hermes's own settings.

Another program

1. Choose **Another program**.
2. Type the command name, the same word you would type in PowerShell to start it. Example: `gemini`.
3. Click **Connect**. The window looks for that command and starts it in the project folder. If Windows cannot find the command, the red line says it is not installed.

> You do not install every agent. Install the one this computer will run. A computer that only joins the room and opens the shared folder does not need any of them.

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9. The host and their agent make the plan

A plan is the list of parts and one sentence that says how those parts connect. Example: two parts named Canvas and Tools, and the sentence "The toolbar calls the canvas. The canvas is the only writer of the picture."

The host does not write a file and does not use PowerShell. The host and the host's own agent work the plan out together in the window. When the host says the plan is a go, that agent sends the plan to every agent in the room, including itself, and they start the work.

1. On the host, finish section 6 and connect the host's agent in section 8. The other computers should already be in the room with their own agents connected.
2. Open the **Live** tab. Because this computer is the host, you see **Plan with your agent**.
3. In the box, describe the work in ordinary words. Example: "We are building a paint app. One part is the canvas. One part is the tools. The tools call the canvas, and the canvas is the only thing that changes the picture." Click **Talk**.

4. Your agent answers in **Talking**, under the box. Read it. If something is wrong, type the correction and click **Talk** again. Keep going until the title, the one connecting sentence, and the parts are what you want.
5. Click **The plan is a go**. Your agent publishes that plan to the room. Each agent, including yours, is given a part and starts working. You see the parts next to their names under **Agents**.

> The other people do not type the plan. Their agents receive their parts from the room and start. The host is the one who talks with their agent and the one who clicks The plan is a go.

When your part is done, open **Live** and click **Finish my share**. That tells the room your share is finished. It does not merge the files into one result. If the folder is a GitHub project, that click also pushes the commit. The host can click **Send to GitHub** without finishing a part, and **Close this part** to close that part for everyone on it.

The host can give the folder to another computer. On Live, choose that computer and click **Hand the source**. That computer must keep Team Code Link open. It copies the folder and then shares it. Live says who the folder is moving to.

Live also lists each file someone is editing. A second Cursor or Claude save of that file is refused. If another editor changes a held file, that save is put back. After the folder is quiet, the source computer pushes it to GitHub when the folder has a remote. Closing a part, or finishing the last share, pushes that result to main. Live says Merged to GitHub when that succeeds, and leaves the part unfinished when the same lines disagree.

> If the red line says to connect your agent first, open the Agent tab and click Connect, then come back to Live. The plan box is only on the host's window.

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10. How to share a file

There are two ways a file moves between computers. Tailscale shares the live folder, so a file saved on the host shows up for the other person immediately. GitHub is a saved copy on the internet: you send a file up to GitHub, and the other person downloads that copy. Team Code Link can use either one. It does not use Tailscale's separate "send a file" menu. The whole project folder is the share.

Use Tailscale when people are working at the same time and the host computer can stay on. Use GitHub when you want a copy that remains after the host is turned off, or when someone new needs the files without the host being awake. Many projects use both: work in the Tailscale folder, and send a snapshot to GitHub when you want a saved copy.

Share a file over Tailscale

Do sections 3 and 6 first. The host must be running Team Code Link as administrator, Tailscale must say connected on both computers, and the top bar on the host must show a source path that starts with `\\`.

A share path has two parts. In `\\office\Shared`, `office` is the host computer and `Shared` is the project name you typed. If the path uses a number, such as `\\100.125.156.83\Shared`, that number is the host's Tailscale address. Either form is the door to the same folder.

1. On the host, open the folder you chose with **Choose folder**. That is the real folder on the disk, for example `C:\Users\YourName\Documents\SharedProject`. It is not the `\\` path. The `\\` path is how other computers see this same folder.
2. Put the file in that folder. You can drag it in from the desktop, or use File, Save as, and choose this folder. The file name can have spaces. Example: save `notes.txt` directly inside `SharedProject`, not inside a different folder.
3. On the other computer, finish section 7 so Team Code Link has joined. Look at **Source** on the top bar and copy the whole path, including the two backslashes at the start.
4. On that other computer, open File Explorer. That is the yellow folder icon. Click the long address box at the top, paste the path, and press Enter.
5. You should see `notes.txt`. Double-click it to open it. To edit it in Cursor, in Cursor choose File, Open Folder, and paste that same `\\` path.

> The other person should see the file without you emailing it. If you add a second file to the host folder, it appears in the same File Explorer window after a refresh. Press F5 in that window to refresh.

> If File Explorer says it cannot find the path, check that the host is on, Tailscale is connected on both sides, and Team Code Link on the host was started with Run as administrator. If Windows asks for a username and password, the share did not get created. On the host, close Team Code Link, start it again with Run as administrator, and click Host and share. The file still has to be inside the chosen folder, not only on the desktop.

One person should edit a given file at a time. If a Cursor agent already holds the file, another Cursor agent's save is refused. Saving from Notepad or another editor is not refused. The host computer must stay on. Closing the host, or disconnecting Tailscale, hides the folder from everyone else.

Share a file through GitHub

GitHub is a website that stores a project. A repository is one project on that website. A commit is a saved snapshot of the files, with a sentence that says what changed. Push means send that snapshot

from your computer up to GitHub. Pull means download the latest snapshot from GitHub onto a computer.

Team Code Link's GitHub choice copies a repository down into the folder the first time the folder has no project history. It does not send later files up by itself. The steps below are how you send a file up, and how the other person gets it.

1. On the host, create a GitHub account at https://github.com/signup if you do not have one. Sign in.
2. Click the plus sign in the top right of GitHub, then **New repository**. Name it with letters, numbers, and hyphens, such as `shared-project`. Choose **Private** if only invited people should see it. Leave "Add a README" turned off if the folder on your computer already has files. Click **Create repository**.
3. On that new repository page, click **Settings**, then **Collaborators**, and invite the other person by their GitHub username. They must accept the invite. A private repository is invisible to them until they accept.
4. Copy the repository address from the green **Code** button. It looks like `https://github.com/yourname/shared-project`. Copy the HTTPS address, not the SSH one.
5. In Team Code Link on the host, set **Project lives** to **In a GitHub repo, copied into a folder here**. Paste that address into **GitHub repo**. Click **Choose folder** and pick an empty folder. Run the program as administrator and click **Host and share**. If the folder does not already contain a hidden `.git` folder, the program downloads the repository into it. An empty new repository downloads as an empty folder, which is fine.
6. Put the file you want to share into that folder, the same way as the Tailscale steps. Example: `notes.txt` inside the folder.
7. Git must be installed (section 4). Open PowerShell. Go to the project folder and send the file to GitHub. Replace the folder and write a real sentence after `-m`:

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Documents\SharedProject
git init
git add notes.txt
git commit -m "Add notes.txt."
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/yourname/shared-project.git
git push -u origin main
```

`git init` starts history in this folder. Skip that line if the folder was already copied from GitHub and `git status` works. `git add notes.txt` chooses that one file. `git commit` saves the snapshot on this computer. `git remote add origin` tells Git which GitHub address to use. Skip that line if it says the remote already exists. `git push` sends the snapshot to GitHub. The first push opens a browser

window so you can sign in to GitHub. Finish that sign-in. When the command ends without an error, open the repository page in a browser and you should see `notes.txt`.

8. On the other computer, install Git the same way. Open PowerShell and download the project. Pick an empty folder name at the end:

```
cd C:\Users\TheirName\Documents
git clone https://github.com/yourname/shared-project.git SharedProject
```

`git clone` creates `SharedProject` and puts `notes.txt` inside it. They can also set Team Code Link's **Project lives** to the GitHub option, paste the same address, choose an empty folder, and click **Join**. That copies the repository once.

9. The next time the host adds or changes a file, send only the new snapshot. From the project folder:

```
git add notes.txt
git commit -m "Update notes.txt."
git push
```

On the other computer, open PowerShell in their copy of the folder and download that snapshot:

```
cd C:\Users\TheirName\Documents\SharedProject
git pull
```

`git pull` brings in what was pushed. Their `notes.txt` then matches the host's saved snapshot. It does not update by itself. They run `git pull` when they want the new copy.

> Do not commit passwords, the room code, or a file named `.team-link-client.json`. That file is how this computer signs into the room. It should stay on the computer. If `git status` lists it, do not `git add` it.

> Tailscale shows the file as soon as it is saved in the host folder, while the host is on. GitHub shows the file after a successful push, and the other person sees it after clone or pull, even if the host is later turned off.

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11. Skills, settings, and leaving

Skills. Open the Skills tab on each computer before you connect. The list is discovered on that computer. It is not typed in. Uncheck a skill to keep this agent from bringing it. Then click Connect, or Host and share, again so the room receives the new list.

Settings. The Settings tab stores the computer name, agent name, project, folder, and whether this PC hosts or joins. **Save** writes that down for the next time you open the window. Save does not enter the room. Host and share, Join, and Connect do.

Leaving. A seat stays in the room until that agent leaves or someone removes it. Closing a laptop lid does not remove the seat. There is no timer that drops a quiet person. On the older room board, a signed-in conductor can remove a seat. The room code alone cannot remove anyone.

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12. When the message does not match what you expected

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Tailscale not connected	Install Tailscale or click Sign in with Tailscale. Wait until the icon by the clock says Connected.
Connected, but the other PC is not in the Tailscale list	They are on a different tailnet. Invite them from the admin users page and have them accept.
Source stays none, red line about administrator	Close the program. Right-click the exe, Run as administrator, and click Host and share again.
No computer on Tailscale accepted that code	The host window is closed, the code was typed wrong, or Host and share was not run as administrator. Section 6.
The seat is in the room. The agent program is not running.	The name was registered. Cursor’s agent did not stay running. Click Connect again after Cursor is installed and signed in.
The cursor program is not installed	Install Cursor on that computer, open it once, then click Connect.
The room did not start	Another Team Code Link window is already using the room. Close it and host again.
The plan box is missing on Live	This computer is not the host. Only the host plans with their agent. Section 9.
The other person cannot open the \\ path	The host is off, Tailscale is disconnected, or Host and share was not run as administrator. Section 10, Tailscale.
git push asks you to sign in, or says authentication failed	Finish the browser sign-in Git opened. The other person must be invited as a collaborator on a private repository.
The file is on GitHub but not on the other computer	They have an old copy. In their project folder they run git pull. Section 10, GitHub.

13. What this program does not do yet

- It does not connect the Cursor chat that is already open. Connect starts a separate Cursor agent program.
- That program runs one turn and exits. It does not sit in the room forever. Another turn starts when you click Connect again, or when the conductor sends new instructions to a seat that is already on an active part.
- The host's agent publishes the plan after the host clicks The plan is a go. The window does not ask anyone to write a plan file.
- The window cannot mark a part finished or merge the parts back into one branch.
- A person saving outside Cursor is not blocked by the file lock.
- An agent name other than `cursor` connects only when a program with that exact name is installed. Only Cursor is wired to the room tools by the Connect button.
- Choosing GitHub in the window copies the repository into the folder once. It does not push later files. Section 10 is how you send those files up with git push, and how the other person downloads them with git pull.
- The other computers download `Team.Code.Link.exe` from section 4, then do sections 3, 7, and 8 on their own PC.

Host first. Confirm the four items on the top bar. Then have each other person join with the code, then connect their own agent.